

# Acme Corporation Employee Handbook

HR Policy Manual — Edition 2024

## Section 1. Introduction

This handbook describes the employment policies of Acme Corporation for the 2024 calendar year. It supersedes the 2023 edition in full. Acme operates in 18 countries and employs approximately 3,900 people. This edition introduces a substantially expanded parental leave policy, a four-day anchor-week for summer months, and a caregiver support program.

## Section 2. Working Hours and Remote Work

### 2.1 Standard Hours

Standard working hours remain 40 hours per week. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local time. During July and August, Acme operates a Summer Fridays program where the last Friday of each month is a company-wide non-working day.

### 2.2 Hybrid Work Model

Employees may work remotely up to 4 days per week. Wednesday is designated as the company-wide in-office anchor day for all employees in locations with an Acme office. Tuesday and Thursday remain team anchor days at manager discretion. Fully remote arrangements require VP approval and are reviewed quarterly.

The home office stipend increases to \$800 for new remote workers and an additional \$200 refresh is available every 24 months. The monthly internet allowance increases to \$60. Acme also offers a co-working space reimbursement of up to \$200 per month for fully remote employees without access to an Acme office.

## Section 3. Compensation

### 3.1 Salary Reviews

Merit increase pool for 2024 was set at 4.5 percent. Salary reviews continue in March with adjustments effective April 1. A new geo-differentiated pay structure is introduced for employees in high-cost metropolitan areas.

### 3.2 Bonus Plan

The annual performance bonus target is 12 percent for individual contributors, 18 percent for managers, and 28 percent for directors. Spot bonus ceiling increases to \$10,000. A new referral bonus of \$4,000 is offered for successful senior engineering hires.

### **3.3 Wellness and Family Stipend**

The wellness stipend remains \$75 monthly. A new family stipend of \$150 monthly is introduced for employees with dependent children under 18, covering childcare, tutoring, and educational expenses.

## **Section 4. Leave Policies**

### **4.1 Paid Time Off**

Full-time employees accrue 25 days of PTO per year, plus 12 company holidays. Accrual is 2.08 days per month. Carryover increases to 10 days. PTO requests must be submitted at least 5 business days in advance.

### **4.2 Sick Leave**

Paid sick leave remains 10 days per year. A new mental health day program grants 3 additional paid days per year for mental health recovery, which do not require a physician's note.

### **4.3 Parental Leave**

Effective January 2024, parental leave increases to 20 weeks of fully paid leave for primary caregivers and 12 weeks for secondary caregivers. Leave may be taken in up to three separate blocks within 18 months of the child's birth, adoption, or placement. Employees must notify HR at least 60 days in advance, or as soon as practicable in emergency situations. Parental leave is available to all employees regardless of gender or path to parenthood, including surrogacy and adoption.

### **4.4 Bereavement Leave**

Bereavement leave remains 7 days for immediate family and 3 days for extended family. A new provision allows up to 2 days of paid travel leave for funerals requiring international travel.

### **4.5 Caregiver Leave**

Caregiver leave expands to 6 weeks of paid leave per year for employees caring for a seriously ill immediate family member. Certification from a physician is required. Caregiver leave may be taken intermittently.

## **Section 5. Code of Conduct**

### **5.1 Standards**

All employees must complete compliance training by April 30 each year. New modules on AI ethics and responsible use of generative tools are added and mandatory for all employees.

### **5.2 Reporting Violations**

The Ethics Hotline and web portal remain available. A new mobile reporting app is launched for on-the-go incident reporting.

## **Section 6. Separation**

### **6.1 Notice Period**

Voluntary resignation notice remains 30 days for individual contributors and 60 days for managers and above. A new garden leave provision applies to employees with access to trade secrets.